

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1110

By Capley

A RESOLUTION to honor NASCAR legend Sterling Marlin.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing a native Tennessean who has distinguished himself as one of the greatest race car drivers of all-time, namely Sterling Burton Marlin from Maury County; and

WHEREAS, Sterling Marlin is the son of another stock-car racing legend, the late Coo Coo Marlin, and he proudly followed in his father's footsteps to make his own mark on the track; and

WHEREAS, during his thirty-three-year and 748-race career (1976-2010), Sterling Marlin won numerous Cup races and became a legend in his own right; and

WHEREAS, Sterling Marlin's consecutive victories in the Daytona 500 in 1994 and 1995 are his most memorable accomplishments in NASCAR; his back-to-back Daytona 500 wins placed him in the elite company of Richard Petty and Cale Yarbrough as only the third driver to achieve this incredible feat; and

WHEREAS, making his NASCAR debut in 1983, he was named Rookie of the Year in recognition of his great potential; and

WHEREAS, Sterling Marlin won two races each at the renowned Darlington, Talladega, Charlotte, and Michigan speedways during his career; and

WHEREAS, he also won the UAW-DaimlerChrysler 400 at Las Vegas Motor Speedway two times and 1996's Firecracker 400 for his third victory at Daytona International Speedway; and

WHEREAS, after making his debut at Nashville Speedway USA (now Nashville Fairgrounds Speedway) in 1976, Sterling Marlin was a three-time track champion (1980-1982) at this historic racecourse; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Sterling Marlin was named Tennessee Professional Athlete of the Year in 1995 and 1996 and was a nominee for the award again in 2002; and

WHEREAS, after his retirement from racing, he was deservedly recognized as one of NASCAR's 75 Greatest Drivers in 2023; he has also been inducted into the Nashville Fairgrounds Speedway Hall of Fame, Tennessee Sports Hall of Fame, and Daytona Stock Car Racing Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Marlin has frequently appeared in national media both during his career and since his retirement, even once competing against another NASCAR driver and his team on *Family Feud*; his most recent appearance was on Dale Earnhardt, Jr.'s podcast; and

WHEREAS, a graduate of Spring Hill High School, Sterling Marlin excelled in basketball and football there and served as captain of the football team during his senior year while playing quarterback and linebacker; he accomplished all this while also regularly working on his father's race car; and

WHEREAS, Sterling Marlin has been and continues to be an outstanding ambassador for Maury County and the State of Tennessee, and he is most worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor NASCAR legend Sterling Marlin, salute his illustrious career in racing, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

